

A weather depiction chart details surface conditions as derived from METAR and other surface observations. It is prepared and transmitted by computer every 3 hours beginning at 0100 Zulu time (0100Z), and is valid at the time of the plotted data. Designed to be used for flight planning, it gives an overall picture of the weather across the United States. *[Figure 4-30]*

A detailed explanation of a station model is depicted in the previous discussion of surface analysis charts.

A radar summary chart [Figure 4-31] is a computer-generated graphical display of a collection of automated radar weather reports (SDs). The chart is published hourly, 35 minutes past the hour. It displays areas of precipitation as well as information regarding the characteristics of the precipitation.

- No information—if information is not reported, the chart will read “NA.” If no echoes are detected, the chart will read “NE.”
- Precipitation intensity contours—intensity can be described as one of six levels and is shown on the chart by three contour intervals.
- Height of tops—the heights of the echo tops are given in hundreds of feet MSL.
- Movement of cells—individual cell movement is indicated by an arrow pointing in the direction of movement. The speed of movement in knots is the number at the top of the arrow head. “LM” indicates little movement.

